# Toxic Behaviors

## Negative Talk

Consistent negativity — "Nothing ever goes right for me." Limit contact; steer talks to solutions.

Blaming others — "It's not my fault; the team let me down." Ask calmly what they will do next.

Constant criticism — "You call that a presentation? It was boring." Give one useful suggestion.

Playing the victim — "Why does this always happen to me?" Point to one thing they control.

## Control and Manipulation

Manipulative behavior — "If you really cared, you would help me." Set clear boundaries, then hold them.

Boundary pushing — "Why are you keeping this a secret?" State your limit once, then enforce it.

Gaslighting — "That never happened; you remember it wrong." Keep notes and trust yourself.

Passive-aggressive — "I'm fine," said with a sigh. Ask directly what is really wrong.

## Drama and Self-Absorption

Drama and chaos — "You won't believe what happened today!" Stay neutral; don't take sides.

Self-centered — "Why should I help? What's in it for me?" Say clearly what you need.

Jealousy and envy — "I can't believe you got that promotion." Share your wins without competing.

Hot and cold — "I'll help" one day, gone the next. Write agreements down and follow up.

## Discussion

Which of these signs have you seen in a coworker or a friend?

"I'm fine," said with a sigh — why is passive-aggression so common?

How do you tell a bad day from a toxic pattern over time?

What is a polite way to set a boundary with a relative?

Someone gaslights you about a work meeting. What do you do next?

Is it ever right to cut someone off completely? Give an example.

How do you stay calm when someone twists what you said?

Why do some people play the victim? What do they get from it?

How do you handle constant criticism without starting a fight?

Have you ever been the toxic one? What made you change?

Is it better to confront a toxic person or quietly avoid them?

What is one sentence you use to end a draining conversation?

Do you keep a record when you disagree with someone at work?

When should you stop trying to fix a difficult person?